

GA-ST-01

Positive Discipline & Prohibition of Corporal Punishment

Respectful behaviour guidance that protects every child's safety, dignity, voice, and right to learn.

APPLIES TO

Gardner Academy employees and relevant staff

AUTHORITY

Gardner Academy staff standard

01 Policy statement

Gardner Academy prohibits corporal punishment, degrading treatment, intimidation, humiliation, and the use of force as punishment. Behaviour guidance must be calm, proportionate, respectful, and focused on helping the child learn what to do next.

02 Prohibited conduct

Staff must never:

- Hit, slap, spank, shake, pinch, push, or physically punish a child.
- Use painful exercise, positions, restraint, food, water, sleep, or toilet access as punishment.
- Threaten, mock, shame, insult, frighten, humiliate, or use demeaning sarcasm.
- Label a child as bad, naughty, difficult, lazy, or incapable.
- Use collective punishment for the actions of an individual.
- Retaliate against a child who speaks, reports, or asks for help.

03 Positive practice

Staff should describe the behaviour, state the safe or respectful action they want to see, offer developmentally appropriate choices, help children regulate, guide repair, and teach replacement skills. Consequences must be related, reasonable, and explained without humiliation.

Immediate safety

Physical intervention is never a punishment. In an immediate safety emergency, only the minimum necessary action may be taken to prevent harm, in line with approved safeguarding procedures and staff training. Every intervention must be reported and recorded promptly.

Reporting

Every staff member has a duty to report any corporal punishment they witness. Any observed, disclosed, or suspected corporal punishment, degrading treatment, or inappropriate physical intervention must be reported immediately to the designated safeguarding lead or school head. Staff must record facts and must not investigate the allegation themselves.